



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

adhy+ātma+(kuśalas tv* Ckuśaleṣv*) anyo* | nivartya*ātmānam ātmanā |
kiṃ+cin* na*asti*iti saṃpaśyann* | ākiṃcanya* iti smṛtaḥ | | 12.63 |
tato* muñjād* iṣṭkā*iva | śakuniḥ pañjarād* iva |
kṣetra+jña* niḥsrto* dehān* | mukta* ity* abhidhīyate | | 12.64 |
etat tat paramaṃ* brahma | nir+liṅgaṃ* dhruvam a+kṣaram |
yan* mokṣa* iti tattva+jñāḥ | kathayanti manīṣiṇaḥ | | 12.65 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It speaks of the wise individual who, skilled in the inner realm (adhyātma-kuśala), turns away from that which is unskillful, guiding the self by the self. This turning away isn't mere avoidance, but a conscious redirection of your energy and attention towards inner peace and understanding. Seeing that "nothing exists" in the sense of permanent, independent selfhood, this person is known as possessing "nothingness" (ākiṃcanya), a state free from attachment and grasping.

The scripture then paints a vivid image of release. Just as a reed is drawn from its sheath, or a bird escapes its cage, so too does the Knower of the Field (kṣetra-jña), the self-aware consciousness, emerge from the body. This is what is meant by liberation (mukta). It's not annihilation, but a transcendence of the physical and mental constructs that bind you.

This liberation, the ultimate goal, is described as the supreme Brahman, without characteristics (nir-liṅgaṃ), unwavering (dhruvam), and imperishable (a-kṣaram). The wise, the truth-knowers (tattva-jñāḥ), the thoughtful (manīṣiṇaḥ), call this state Moksha – freedom. This freedom, however, isn't a distant, unattainable ideal. It's a potential inherent within you, waiting to be realized through diligent self-reflection and the letting go of limiting beliefs.

In modern life, this wisdom encourages you to examine your attachments, your clinging to identities and possessions. It invites you to cultivate inner stillness amidst the chaos of daily existence. By understanding the impermanence of all things, you can loosen the grip of fear and anxiety, moving towards a state of greater peace and freedom, even within the confines of your everyday life. The cage might represent your own self-imposed limitations. The bird represents the liberated self, ready for the boundless sky.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "cage" are you currently residing in, and what is one small step you can take today to open the door?